

ULTIMATE GAMING PERIPHERALS BUYING CHEAT-SHEET

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When it comes to PC peripherals, making the right choices can significantly impact your overall PC experience. For keyboards to mice, it's crucial to consider your needs, preferences, and budget. Here's a buying guide to help you select the ideal peripherals for your PC setup.

1 Keyboards:

■ Membrane Keyboards:

Membrane keyboards are affordable but less durable than mechanical ones. They suffice for general use but not for intense typing or gaming sessions.

- **Mechanical Keyboards:** In addition to being a lot more robust, mechanical keyboards offer a wide range of switch types (linear, tactile, clicky), allowing you to customise your gaming and typing experience.



- **Switch Brands:** Established brands like Cherry offer durability and reliability, but cheaper alternatives like Kailh and Outemu provide similar performance (at a small cost to durability) at a lower cost.

- **Software Support:** Established brands often come with better software support and customer care, but they come at a higher price point.

- **High-End Options:** Optical-mechanical switches offer the most accuracy with the lowest response times. They also come at the highest premium. Additional considerations include modular keyboards which allow you to change form factor on the fly.

2 Considerations:

- **Switch Type:** Choose between linear, tactile, and clicky switches based on your preference.
- **Actuation Force:** Different switches



require varying force to register all your keypresses.

- **Layout:** Decide on the keyboard layout (standard, TKL, mini) that suits your needs.
- **N-Key Rollover:** Essential for gaming, it allows multiple simultaneous keypresses.
- **Backlighting:** Useful for typing in dark environments; RGB lighting is completely optional.

3 Mice:

- **Casual Use:** For general and casual users, comfort is a top priority. Choose a mouse that feels comfortable during extended use.

- **Comfort Factors:** Consider the shape (ambidextrous or ergonomic) and weight of the mouse.

- **Gaming and Power Users:** Gamers should select mice based on their gaming genre. MMORPG and MOBA



gamers benefit from mice with extra buttons, while FPS gamers need mice with great sensors and lightweight designs.

- **Sensor and Polling Rate:** A high DPI (dots per inch) or CPI (counts per inch) is not always necessary; select a DPI setting that suits your preference.
- **RGB Lighting:** RGB lighting is not essential, and it often increases the cost of the mouse.

In summary, consider whether you prioritize comfort, gaming performance, or additional features. While there are affordable options available, investing in reputable brands can provide better software support and durability. Make sure to match your peripheral choices to your use case, and you'll enhance your overall gaming experience. **d**